Sofia's Season Workbook

2026–27 · Glass House Dance · Team PITCH

Four dances
★ Solo · Stay a Little Longer · lyrical · Hannah / Ms. Brittany
★ Trio · Enjoy the Silence · contemporary · Larisa
★ PITCH jazz · Groove Is in the Heart · Isadora
★ PITCH contemporary · song TBD · Ms. Brittany

First show: Winter Showcase, Jan 8–10, 2027 · rehearsal Sat Jan 2
First comp: Hollywood Connection, Jan 22–24

Print pages 12–16 again whenever you need fresh trackers.

My season

Where I'm going and what a normal week looks like

Events

When	What	My dances	Good to know
Jan 2	Mandatory rehearsal	All	Be back from break!
Jan 8–10	Winter Showcase	Solo, trio, groups, class dances	First time an audience sees the dances
Jan 15–17	Press Play Seattle	Classes only	Famous teachers; rest, eat, sleep
Jan 22–24	Hollywood Connection, Renton	Solo, trio, groups	Venue IS the hotel; Sunday wrap party; ballrooms are cold
Feb 19–21	Ryze Seattle	Solo, trio, groups	Rehearsal Thu Feb 18; surprise Friday class
Feb 26–28	iD, Tacoma	Solo + trio	Concert-style show; loud; free photos & video
Mar 12–14	Gravit8, Seattle	Solo, trio, groups	Free everything; judges record spoken critiques
Apr 30–May 2	Hollywood Vibe Seattle	Groups (solo/trio TBA)	Faculty show Sunday; Saturday can run past midnight
May 14–16	Showstopper, Tacoma	TBA	America's oldest comp; free to watch; every routine livestreamed
Jun 19–20	Glass House Ball 11	All	Outdoor festival show, food trucks

Studio week

Mon	Ballet III 4:30 · Acro II/III 5:30 · Jazz Tech III 6:30
Tue	Hip Hop II 5:30 · Ballroom 6:30
Wed	Contemporary III 6:30 · solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany when booked
Sat	Co Tech 10:00 · PITCH rehearsal 11:00
Trio	Privates with Larisa, 1–2× a month

Home week

Thu	Strong + bendy + trio section + solo run
Fri	Technique + this week's trick + solo run
Sun	FILMED solo run + trio section + stretch
Mon/Tue	REST at home. Studio days are heavy.

30–40 minutes. Two short practices beat one long one.

The road to January

Own it · to Oct 25 · every dance from memory, no cues
Clean it · Oct 26–Nov 29 · feet, knees, arms, eyes
Perform it · Nov 30–Jan 2 · focal points, stamina, costume runs
Rest up · from Dec 28 · one run a day, sleep, nothing new

★ Solo · Stay a Little Longer

Lyrical · choreography Hannah · rehearsals Ms. Brittany · costume: Kellé Blossom Within, blush (LC)

Music map (2:04)

SOFT 0:00–0:48 · the "feel it" half	FULL 0:48–1:52 · the tricks half	fade

The big beat lands about every 2.3 seconds in the loud half. Finish every shape ON it. The music is fully gone at 2:00: hold the last shape until then.

Where the big moments land

~0:11	Drop to the floor, seated fold
~0:15	Side-sit leg reach — leg to the ceiling
~0:17	Leg fans down, slide out long
~0:19	Rolls down to the elbow
~0:34	Attitude, arms up
0:48	**Music swells**
~0:50	Cartwheel — on the swell
~1:08	Walkover / handstand, then donut roll
~1:42	Floor kick
~1:50	Passé turns
1:53–2:00	Floor ending — hold it

Already strong

- Smooth floor work, no crashing
- Big full-body reach on the lunge
- Brave acro: cartwheel, walkover, clean handstand line
- Straight standing leg in attitude and passé

My fixes

- ☐ **Point + straighten.** Every floor extension. Side-sit leg reach too — even on the way down.
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** Clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no teacher. Every section has a spot.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe to the side of the knee, on relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Head stays up until hands go down.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** arms down, head ALL the way back. No chin tuck.
- ☐ **Hold the ending** to 2:00.

Where do I look? (fill in with Ms. Brittany)

Opening walk	
Floor work	
Attitude / standing	
Cartwheel → walkover	
Floor kick / turns	
Ending	

Ms. Brittany's top 3 right now

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

★ Solo tricks · one per Friday

Rotate through all eight, then start again. Warm up first, every time.

1 · Side-sit leg reach (~0:15)

- [ ] Sit on one hip, hand on the floor. Leg straight up: 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 down. 6 each side
- [ ] Arm slides up the leg, fingers past the toes
- [ ] Cue: **push the floor, reach the toe** — knee stays straight as the leg fans down

2 · Side extension / attitude

- [ ] Développé side at a counter: 4 up, hold 2, 4 down ×6
- [ ] Side-lying leg lifts 2×12
- [ ] Standing heel DOWN, hip square

3 · Cartwheel on the swell

- [ ] 4 counts before: reach, look, place
- [ ] Cartwheel over a tape line, legs straight
- [ ] Track from 0:44, land + arms on the beat ×5

4 · Walkover / handstand line

- [ ] Wrists first. Wall handstand 3×10–15s
- [ ] Kick up to vertical ×5; split at the top ×5
- [ ] Kick-overs only with a spotter until cleared

5 · Floor kick

- [ ] 8 slow kicks each side, 4 up, 4 down, point at the top
- [ ] Kick from the hip, keep the back long

6 · Passé turns

- [ ] Passé balance on relevé 10s both sides
- [ ] Quarter ×8, half ×8, singles ×10
- [ ] Sticker on the wall; arms hug a beach ball

7 · The ending

- [ ] Last 15 seconds of the real track ×5, hold, count 8 more
- [ ] Face stays in the story until silence

8 · Donut roll (after the walkover)

- [ ] Warm the back: cobra, then seal, 20s each
- [ ] Kneeling backbend hands to heels 3×5s; bridge 3×10s
- [ ] Donut shape: knees bent, chest open, eyes to ceiling then wall
- [ ] Arms down, **head ALL the way back**. No chin tuck.

How to practice any trick

- **Slow first.** Half speed 3×.
- **Film one.** Watch. Compare to the picture in your head.
- **Fix one thing.**
- **Put it back in the dance** with the counts before and after.
- **Stop before tired.**

★ Trio · Enjoy the Silence

Contemporary · Larisa · with Hannah (pink skirt) and Lauren (black shorts) · 2:24 final cut, ~86 BPM

What the music does

Almost no volume change until a small lift at 1:32; fades at 2:12. The music does NOT make the dynamics — the three of you do, with stillness against speed. Hold the last picture past 2:12.

The map

0:00	Kneeling opening
0:02	Lunges — back leg long, pointed
0:04	Floor phrase: leg extensions + shoulder stand
0:22	Kneeling STILLNESS — one shared focus
0:28	Low crawl, arabesque on knees, seated extensions
0:42	Rise + traveling CANON — know YOUR start count
1:04	Runs + lunges (Lauren's acro)
1:12	Arms-up phrase → lunges to floor
1:36	THREE BRIDGES — the picture
1:50	Traveling triangle
2:06	Ending: three levels on the floor. Hold.

Already strong

- Shoulder stand: straight, pointed vertical leg — cleanest of the three
- Lunge at 0:02: long pointed back leg
- Solid bridge at 1:36
- Runs full-out

My fixes (for the privates)

- [ ] Eyes: no mirror at 0:02; in the 0:22 stillness all three eyelines agree
- [ ] Arabesque on knees (0:30): match the agreed height, lock the knee
- [ ] Canon waiting (0:52–0:58): hold a SHAPE with intent, never stand "off"
- [ ] Arms overhead (0:58): straight, not hands to the head — match Hannah's line
- [ ] I'm often upstage: dance BIGGER when farthest from the judges
- [ ] Match Lauren's size — she dances the biggest

Larisa's rule

Memorize first. Cleaning happens in privates, 1–2× a month.

Home: 10 min Thursday + 10 min Sunday, one section at a time, with the video, then without. Whole dance with no video by end of October. Track it on page 13.

Costume ideas

Floor-heavy dance: fitted bodice, brief or short, no full loose skirt, nothing stoned on the back. Larisa's idea: blues with cutouts. Mine: Silver Hush (pewter mesh over blush), Storm Cloud (charcoal/navy mesh, silver at the collar), Ivory Still. Hair low and sleek.

★ PITCH jazz · Groove Is in the Heart

Isadora · Saturdays 11:00 · 2:31 cut at ~123 BPM (one 8-count ≈ 3.9 seconds)

Music map

0:00–0:08	Quiet intro
0:08–0:24	Builds
0:24–1:12	Full groove
1:12–1:20	Breakdown — the energy dips
1:20–1:48	Full groove
1:52–1:56	**NEAR SILENCE — freeze completely. Any wobble shows.**
1:56–2:26	Final push
2:26–2:31	Tail

The dance so far

- Opening line: hands behind head, hip pops
- Crouch and walk → runs and leaps
- Formation groups with kicks, jazz square (~0:44)
- Clusters of four with big arm swings (~1:04)
- Traveling hands-behind-head phrase → lines
- Long diagonal line to finish: hip pops, lunges with crossed arms, arms overhead crossed wrists, passé

Already strong

- On the counts with the group in the opening, clusters and closing line
- FRONT of her mini-group at 1:06 with full arm swings — that's the version for every section
- Arms-overhead pose matches the older dancers

My fixes

- ☐ **Stance width:** match the biggest base beside me (2:12, 2:32)
- ☐ **Hands behind head:** elbows WIDE to the sides, not forward
- ☐ **Hip pops:** farther than feels polite
- ☐ **Jazz is sharp:** hit and STOP. No melting
- ☐ **1:52 silence:** total stillness
- ☐ **Eyes:** front, not the teacher

Home focus (10 min)

- Hands-behind-head pose in the mirror, elbows wide
- Closing-line sequence full size, counts out loud
- Count the whole dance out loud while marking — being early or late is the #1 group mistake
- Tape spots for my formations once Isadora gives me my spot sheet

Ask Isadora

- ☐ A front-facing video of the finished dance
- ☐ My spot sheet (formation numbers)

★ PITCH contemporary · song TBD

Ms. Brittany · Saturdays 11:00 · costume: The Line Up Alice Metallic Mesh Unitard, child 12 short inseam

The dance so far

- Low crouch/reach opening → lunges and swinging-arm phrase
- Brief floor moment (~0:10–0:14)
- Tight huddle (~0:56–1:10) that bursts into scattered traveling
- Floor and inversion work (~1:36–1:40)
- Ends in a clump downstage-left with one dancer separated

My fixes

- ☐ **Head checks** to the mirror (1:33, 1:35) — focal points instead
- ☐ **Arms in second** at or above shoulder, fingers long (1:35)
- ☐ **Straddle fold:** hinge at the hips, weight mid-foot, not on the heels (1:36–1:38)
- ☐ **Feet** parallel or turned out in the wide stance, never turned in

Already strong

- Cartwheel at 1:39 is one of the cleanest in the room: straight legs, controlled landing, straight into the next shape
- Dances full size — wide second matches the tall dancers
- Quiet floor entries
- Timing with the group in the close section

What wins in a large group

- Unison first: every phrase has a count for the shape's finish
- Spacing: find your window; don't drift to center
- Energy match: the fullest dancer sets the standard
- Eyes: wandering eyes are more visible in a group than a solo
- The final clump snaps into place on a beat and holds

Costume care

Made to order, final sale. Metallic mesh dulls where it rubs the floor — rehearse in practice clothes; costume only for run-throughs and shows.

Ask Ms. Brittany

- ☐ Song title, so I can learn the music map
- ☐ Front-facing video + my spot sheet

The home routine

30–40 minutes · Thu · Fri · Sun · warm up first, every time

Warm up · 5 min

- [ ] Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings, light jog

Strong · 10 min

- [ ] Hollow hold + superman 3×20s
- [ ] Plank + side plank 2×20–30s
- [ ] Slow relevés 2×15 · single-leg balance 20s each
- [ ] Lying leg lifts, straight knee, 2×10 each

Bendy · 10 min · after warm-up only

- [ ] Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20–30s each
- [ ] Bridge only if the teacher says yes

Technique · 10 min

- [ ] Passé balance on relevé 5–10s both sides
- [ ] 10 single pirouettes each side, spot!
- [ ] Kicks to hip height: straight knee, pointed foot
- [ ] Arms overhead in the mirror: long elbows

The dances · 5–10 min

- [ ] Solo: mark once, FULL OUT once, eyes up
- [ ] Trio: one section from the memory map (Thu, Sun)
- [ ] Groups: the closing-line sequence or hands-behind-head pose, counts out loud
- [ ] Sunday: film the solo. Watch. ONE fix. ONE thing you loved.

Say it before every run

Point. Straighten. Eyes up.
Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Rules that keep me dancing

- Warm up before stretching. A stretch feels like a stretch, never pain.
- No oversplits. No forcing.
- Acro at home only on the mat, or with a spotter.
- If it hurts, stop.
- Sleep and water are part of training.

Rest up (from Dec 28)

- One run a day, max
- No new skills, no deep stretching
- Mini show for family Thu Jan 7
- Early bedtime

Aerial Mission

A cartwheel with NO hands. This year.

What it is

Your cartwheel with no hands. Nobody *jumps* it. **PUSH** the floor away with your front leg, **KICK** the back leg up fast, keep your **CHEST UP** so your hands never need to catch you.

Almost every aerial that fails is the chest dropping — the same "don't drop your head before the cartwheel" note from your solo.

The rules

- Learned in **Monday Acro** with a coach spotting. First tries happen there.
- Mom and Dad don't spot aerials. They film and hold the mat.
- Mat under you for every drill.
- Stop before tired.
- Not in the solo until 20 in a row in class.

The 6 drills · 10 min on the mat

1 Hurdle: step, hurdle, lunge, arms swing up, chest tall ×10
2 Front-leg drive: lunge → tall jump, back leg kicks up ×10 (the engine)
3 One-hand cartwheels: far ×5, near ×5
4 Fingertip cartwheels ×5 — when it's a brush, you're close
5 Wedge cartwheels: two hands → one → brush
6 Strong stuff: jump lunges, single-leg hops, hollow holds

Push. Kick. Chest up. Eyes forward.

Earn it first

Cartwheel skills

- [ ] Fast cartwheel, straight arms + legs, land facing the start
- [ ] One-hand cartwheel FAR hand, 10 clean
- [ ] One-hand cartwheel NEAR hand, 10 clean
- [ ] Dive cartwheel on the mat
- [ ] Round-off: feet together, chest up

Strong enough

- [ ] 10 single-leg squats each leg
- [ ] Hollow hold 30s
- [ ] 20 jump lunges
- [ ] Long jump farther than I am tall

In class

- [ ] Acro teacher set the order
- [ ] First spotted aerials
- [ ] Aerial on the mat, no spot
- [ ] 20 in a row → allowed in a dance!

How long?

Most dancers with a good cartwheel: 4–10 months. The boring drills every week win.

Memory tricks and mind tools

How to learn a dance so it sticks, and how to be brave on stage

Learning a dance

- **One section at a time.** Video → with music → no help. Clean twice before moving on.
- **Say the moves out loud** while you mark. Words are a second memory.
- **Count sheet.** Write a move name in every count box (page 14). The canon and any section where dancers start on different counts need it most.
- **Teach it to Mom.** If you can't say what's next, you don't have it yet.
- **Two short practices beat one long one.**
- **Mirror off.** Once a section is learned, face away from the mirror.

Focal points

Every section of every dance gets a place to look: out to the audience, the floor, the ceiling, or a partner. Write them in the I LOOK AT… column (Toolkit p.4) or a count sheet. Eyes that wander look like "not sure." Eyes that land look like "I mean it."

The Sunday film review

- Watch once with a grown-up
- ONE thing you loved
- ONE thing to fix this week
- Feet, knees, eyes, arms — which was best?

Before you go on

- Breathe in for 4, out for 6, three times
- Say the cue: **Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.**
- Picture the first 8 counts and the last picture
- Do not run the whole dance in the wings. You already know it.

Comp day

- Real breakfast. Water all day. Snacks that aren't messy.
- Check every dance's shoes and costume yourself.
- Warm up properly; mark, don't run, in the hallway.
- Phone away backstage.
- Dance it like Sunday's filmed run. Hold every ending until the music is gone.
- After: one thing you loved. Then go be a kid.

When it goes wrong

Everyone forgets a count sometime. Keep dancing, keep your face in the story, find the next shape you know. Judges see recovery as a skill. Nobody else in the room knows the counts.

What the songs are about (write it)

Stay a Little Longer:

Enjoy the Silence:

Groove Is in the Heart:

Music, videos and people

Everything lives in the Spotlight app too (Dances tab → each dance card)

Music

Dance	Track	Where it is
Solo	Stay a Little Longer — ROSÉ, 2:04 cut	App → Solo card → ▶ Music (file from Hannah)
Trio	Enjoy the Silence, final cut, 2:24	In the app · music ends 2:13, hold to 2:24
Jazz group	Groove Is in the Heart — Deee-Lite, 2:31 cut	App → Jazz card → ▶ Music (file from Isadora)
Contemporary group	TBD	Ask Ms. Brittany

Reference videos (write where they're saved)

Dance	Best reference video	Link / album
Solo	Walkthrough close-up (Sep 25) + music run	
Trio	Finished choreo, 4K (Sep 27)	
Jazz group	Rehearsal (Sep 27) — ask for a front-facing one	
Contemporary group	Rehearsal — ask for a front-facing one	
Sunday solo films	One per week	

Tip: one shared iCloud or Google Photos album per dance. Paste each album link on the dance card in the app.

My teachers

- **Hannah** — solo choreographer
- **Ms. Brittany** — solo rehearsals (when booked), contemporary group
- **Larisa** — trio choreographer, privates; studio office
- **Isadora** — jazz group
- **Acro teacher (Mon)** — aerial progression

Costumes

- **Solo:** Kellé Blossom Within leotard #5448A + skirt #4518A, blush, size LC. Flowers placed with Hannah.
- **Contemporary group:** Line Up Alice Metallic Mesh Unitard, child 12 short inseam
- **Trio:** The Line Up "Sophie" unitard, made to order (size to Larisa)
- **Jazz group:** TBD with Isadora

Packing lists

Check the night before. Then check again in the morning.

Competition day

- [ ] Costume for EVERY dance, in garment bags + backup tights
- [ ] Shoes for every dance (bare feet, turners, sneakers)
- [ ] Hair kit: gel, pins, hairnets, brush, spray, scrunchies
- [ ] Makeup + lashes + remover
- [ ] Warm-up clothes and cover-up
- [ ] Music on phone + backup
- [ ] Water bottle + not-messy snacks
- [ ] Safety pins, tape, sewing kit
- [ ] Blanket or pillow for waiting
- [ ] Charger + battery pack
- [ ] Team jacket (ballrooms are cold)
- [ ] Good-luck note

Studio / rehearsal

- [ ] Right attire for each class
- [ ] Ballet shoes, turners, sneakers
- [ ] Hair pulled back / bun kit
- [ ] Water + snack between classes
- [ ] Phone for filming the solo

Convention weekend

- [ ] Class clothes for each day
- [ ] Sneakers + turners
- [ ] Knee pads
- [ ] Water + snacks
- [ ] Notebook for combos
- [ ] Charger
- [ ] Comfy shoes for hallways
- [ ] Hoodie (rooms get cold)
- [ ] Number / badge
- [ ] Meds + band-aids

My own additions

Practice tracker · to the Showcase

Color a box for every session. One fix per week.

Week of	Thu	Fri	Sun	Filmed?	This week's one fix
Sep 28					
Oct 5					
Oct 12					
Oct 19 · no cues!					
Oct 26					
Nov 2					
Nov 9					
Nov 16					
Nov 23 · light					
Nov 30					
Dec 7					
Dec 14 · costume					
Dec 21					
Dec 28					
Jan 2 REHEARSAL					**SHOWCASE JAN 8–10**

Trick rotation (Fridays)

Write the trick number (1–8 from page 3) in each week:

Oct 2	Oct 9	Oct 16	Oct 23	Oct 30	Nov 6	Nov 13	Nov 20	Dec 4	Dec 11	Dec 18	Jan 1

Trio memory map

Watch one section → with music → no help. Tick only when it runs clean twice.

Time	Section	With video	With music	No help ✓✓
0:00	Kneeling opening	☐	☐	☐
0:02	Lunges	☐	☐	☐
0:04	Floor phrase: leg extensions + shoulder stand	☐	☐	☐
0:22	Kneeling stillness	☐	☐	☐
0:28	Low crawl, arabesque on knees, seated extensions	☐	☐	☐
0:42	Rise + traveling canon (my start count: ____)	☐	☐	☐
1:04	Runs + lunges	☐	☐	☐
1:12	Arms-up phrase → lunges to floor	☐	☐	☐
1:36	Three bridges → lying	☐	☐	☐
1:50	Traveling triangle	☐	☐	☐
2:06	Ending: three levels, hold past 2:12	☐	☐	☐
WHOLE DANCE, no video, nobody marking — goal end of October		☐	☐	☐

Group dances memory map (fill in the sections with your teachers)

Dance	Section	Video	Music	No help
Jazz		☐	☐	☐
Jazz		☐	☐	☐
Jazz		☐	☐	☐
Jazz		☐	☐	☐
Contemp		☐	☐	☐
Contemp		☐	☐	☐
Contemp		☐	☐	☐
Contemp		☐	☐	☐

Count sheet

Dance: _____ · one row per 8 · a move name or a doodle in every count

8 #	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								
13								
14								
15								
16								

Print again for more 8s. The jazz group is about 38 eights; the solo about 26.

This week

Week of _____ · print a fresh one every week

Thursday

- [ ] Warm-up
- [ ] Strong
- [ ] Bendy
- [ ] Trio section: _____
- [ ] Solo: mark + full out

Friday

- [ ] Warm-up
- [ ] Technique
- [ ] Trick #___
- [ ] Group: closing line / pose, counts out loud
- [ ] Solo: full out, eyes up

Sunday

- [ ] Warm-up
- [ ] Solo FILMED from the side
- [ ] Trio section: _____
- [ ] Light stretch
- [ ] Film review →

Focal points I set this week

Sunday film review

One thing I loved

One thing to fix this week (only one!)

Feet, knees, eyes, arms — which was best?

Questions for my teachers

Wins and wobbles

Aerial drill tracker

One row per session · check a drill when it's done · "best thing" in your own words

Date	Hurdle	Drive	1-hand	Fingertip	Wedge	Strong	Best thing today

Ask my Acro teacher

- Which drills at home, which only in class?
- What order do you teach the aerial in?
- What am I ready for right now?